



PARKS & TRAILS ADVISORY BOARD

PTAB Meeting Minutes: February 25, 2026

Present: Colleen O'Neill, Doug Haney, Jimmy Cunningham, Steve Langdon, Peter Waladt, Julianne Stemp, Alli Brunner, Katrina Glynn (Village Staff), Brandon Devito (Public)

Meeting called to order by chair at 6:03 p.m.

1. **Approve January Meeting Minutes:** Motion by Jimmy, Second by Peter.
2. **New Business:**
 - Discuss 2026 Goals and action plans:
 - **Boothe River Park:** Colleen O'Neill, Peter Waladt
 - Explore funding opportunities including Congressional direct spending: writing letters, Gillibrand, Stefanik, Schumer. Local donors and foundations/orgs; try broader orgs like NFCT and APA. Local government: Michael Cashman, Dan Stec.
 - Can Riverwalk funding sync up with the park in some way?
 - Get Hydrologist perspectives - Steve to connect with Scott
 - **Community Bike Ride:** Doug Haney, Julianne Stemp
 - Change time later to 6:30 p.m. but still meeting for Music on the Green after
 - Boost marketing efforts - ROOST, Village, posters, signage upgrade and different locations, school
 - New volunteers to lead rides; Jimmy Cunningham and will recruit others
 - Look into Franklin County Event grant for funding signage and marketing
 - **Church/Pine Corridor Safety Enhancements:** Doug Haney, Stacey Allott
 - Construction design next phase
 - Process to include public feedback/forum
 - **Comprehensive Recreation Plan for Mt. Pisgah:** Alli Brunner, Peter Waladt
 - Secure funding for snowmaking and tubing
 - Tour of Pisgah for Alli and Peter by Ezra
 - Bike trail enhancements (new trail redesign, erosion control) - BETA and Peduzzi trail builders seeking grant funding
 - Pisgah's public communication needs improvement, especially around tubing and operating hours. Perhaps hire a consultant to review and create a plan. Who manages Facebook page?
 - Marketing needs improvement, ask ROOST and FOMP to partner closely together

- **Accessibility Planning:** Mary Thill
 - Village seeking an accessibility review of parks by a consultant
 - Lake Colby: Are the portable toilets and changing room rentals returning/funding?
 - Ken Garwood POW: accessible playground
 - Baldwin: accessible boat launch
 - Riverside: accessible bathroom

- **Downtown Covered Bike Shelter:** Julianne Stemp
 - Continue partnering with Franklin County and DAB
 - Poll local bike shops and bikers and Village re: location for shelter (access, snow removal, etc.)
 - Explore Hotel Saranac or RiverTrail BW for additional locations as a sponsor?
 - Ideally would be removable in Winter.

- **Park Enhancements (partnering with the Village on construction projects):**
 - **Riverside:** Colleen O'Neill
 - **Baldwin:** Stacey Allott
 - **Ken Garwood POW:** Katrina, Ashley Garwood (public)
 - **Riverfront (Ash Trees):** Steve Langdon
 - **William Wallace/Lake Colby:** Julianne Stemp, Mary Thill

- **Rail Trail User Enhancements:** Colleen O'Neill, Doug Haney, Peter Waldt
 - Doug to provide periodic ARTA Updates since he is on their Board
 - Village, PTAB, ROOST and DAB signage and kiosk planning with DEC
 - Activated crossing flashing signs at Fowler's Crossing and Route 3?
 - Brush maintenance at crossings for visibility/safety - Pine Street, Bloomingdale Avenue and Broadway
 - Promote linking Village trail networks - Pisgah, The Pines, Lake Colby

- **Increase Park Usage:** All
 - Ward-Plumadore:
 - Tables, picnic tables, chairs, and umbrellas. Use CEF budget by May \$2509.83, consider combining with DAB if they haven't spent theirs either. And ask DAB about how this fits into Downtown Streetscape Plan.
 - Wildflower/gardens/plantings: involve other orgs like ADK Action, BOCES, NCCC, Paul Smiths College Culinary students and food truck, Petrova, Wild Center, Kathy Steinbrueck,
 - Look into Monarch habitat to support grant funding
 - Giant games (chess, checkers, etc.)
 - Renting to private businesses for event space?
 - Lake Colby Accessibility Equipment:
 - Marketing and outreach for accessible ramp - Check with Bachana on status of other rented equipment.

- **Recycling Program Advocacy:** Doug Haney
 - Partner with DAB and Village via streetscape plan - Downtown locations, Berkeley and Riverside to start
 - Compost bin at Petrova

 - **Park Maintenance Program (Annual in Spring):** All.

 - Riverfront Park Proposal from Brandon Devito, a member of the public: Consider renaming Riverfront Park to Paddler's Park due to its waterfront location and use by local paddling events and outfitters. PTAB receptive to idea and will look into the process more and discuss at a future meeting.

 - Julianne suggested in warmer weather we have PTAB meetings in parks to alternate.
3. Unfinished Business:
- Nothing additional to note as we covered some park updates in discussions above for 2026 plans.
4. Adjourn at 7:25 p.m. Motion by Doug, Second by Jimmy